The examination is being carried out on the **following application documents**

Description, Pages

1, 3-20	filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO			
2	received on	27-04-2016	with letter of	27-04-2016

Claims, Numbers

1-5	received on	26-04-2018	with letter of	25-04-2018

Drawings, Sheets

1/12-12/12	filed with entry into the regional phase before the EPO

1 The subject-matter of claim 1 meets the requirements of Article 52(1) EPC with respect to the available prior art. However, amendment is required to overcome the objections below.

2 It appears that claim 1 should be clarified (Art. 84 EPC) e.g. as follows:

- "the memory means stores a slack prevention control information to ~~follow~~ make an effective length of the auxiliary force transmission part of the pair of left and right assisting units ~~corresponding to~~ follow changes in the joint angle of the user's hip joints" (see e.g. page 13, lines 35-37);
- "the control means is adapted to perform~~s~~ drive control of ...";
- "the information for changing the electrical power that is supplied to the electric motors corresponding to the range of the joint angle is ~~included~~ stored in the memory means as the drive output information, so that whenever the joint angle reaches ~~an angle at preset multiple stages, it is possible to increase or decrease~~ one of a plurality of preset angles, the output of the drive sources can be increased or decreased in stages or gradually" (see e.g. [0047]).
  Remark: The applicant should check that suggested clarification in view of the disclosure of original Japanese disclosure - and should also bring the translation of that paragraph [0047] into conformity with the application as filed, Art. 14(2) EPC.

3 It is noted that the above suggestions are only for assisting the applicant in his decision on how to proceed. They in no way preclude consideration of alternative solutions submitted by the applicant. The responsibility for determining the text of the application (Article 113(2) EPC) and in particular for defining the subject-matter for which protection is sought remains with the applicant.

4 The applicant has brought the translation of the present application into an official language of the EPO into conformity with the application as filed (Japanese) by exchanging in original claim 4 (now introduced into claim 1) the expression "bending prevention control information" with "slack prevention control information" (see Art. 14(2) EPC).

However, the description and the drawings (see Fig. 6) have not been amended. Consequently, claim 1 is not clear in view of the description and the drawings, Art. 84 EPC, Guidelines F-IV, 4.3.

Thus, the expression "slack prevention control information" should be used consistently throughout the description and in Fig. 6.